

GRE-Style Verbal Practice: Q1-Q60 Answer Key

Page 1 contains the compact answer key. Detailed solutions begin on the next page.

Q1. B	Q16. Blank 1: B	Q31. B	Q46. Blank 1: A
Q2. B	Q17. Blank 1: A	Q32. D	Q47. Blank 1: A
Q3. A, B	Q18. Blank 1: A	Q33. A, B, C	Q48. Blank 1: B
Q4. C	Q19. Blank 1: A; Blank 2: D	Q34. C	Q49. Blank 1: A; Blank 2: D
Q5. C	Q20. Blank 1: A; Blank 2: E	Q35. A	Q50. Blank 1: A; Blank 2: D
Q6. F	Q21. Blank 1: A; Blank 2: E	Q36. D	Q51. Blank 1: A; Blank 2: D
Q7. B	Q22. Blank 1: A; Blank 2: D; Blank 3: G	Q37. B	Q52. Blank 1: A; Blank 2: D; Blank 3: G
Q8. B	Q23. Blank 1: A; Blank 2: E; Blank 3: H	Q38. A	Q53. Blank 1: A; Blank 2: D; Blank 3: G
Q9. A, B	Q24. Blank 1: A; Blank 2: E; Blank 3: G	Q39. A, B	Q54. Blank 1: A; Blank 2: D; Blank 3: G
Q10. B	Q25. Blank 1: B, D	Q40. B	Q55. Blank 1: B, D
Q11. B	Q26. Blank 1: B, C	Q41. B	Q56. Blank 1: B, D
Q12. C	Q27. Blank 1: C, E	Q42. E	Q57. Blank 1: B, C
Q13. B	Q28. Blank 1: A, C	Q43. B	Q58. Blank 1: B, D
Q14. A	Q29. Blank 1: B, E	Q44. A	Q59. Blank 1: B, C
Q15. A, B	Q30. Blank 1: A, C	Q45. A, B, C	Q60. Blank 1: B, D

Note: For Text Completion questions with multiple blanks, the answer is shown as the selected option for each blank. For Sentence Equivalence and select-all Reading Comprehension questions, all listed letters are required.

Detailed Solutions

Q1 (Reading Comprehension; source rc-001) - Correct: B

The passage emphasizes that imaging can reveal useful features but does not by itself settle what those features mean. Choice A overstates the role of imaging, while C, D, and E shift to issues the passage does not make central.

Q2 (Reading Comprehension; source rc-002) - Correct: B

The conservators treat imaging as a source of hypotheses requiring corroboration, so they would reject the claim that one imaging result is conclusive. The other choices are compatible with the passage's emphasis on combining evidence.

Q3 (Reading Comprehension; source rc-003) - Correct: A, B

The passage explicitly allows that such a shape may be an abandoned plan, a repair, or a stain, so A and B are supported. It does not say that this evidence by itself proves a different authorship, making C too strong.

Q4 (Reading Comprehension; source rc-004) - Correct: C

The passage says trees can cool neighborhoods, but their effect varies with street geometry, circulation, and time of day. A and B are too sweeping, D reverses the emphasis, and E introduces a cause not discussed.

Q5 (Reading Comprehension; source rc-005) - Correct: C

The passage warns that canopy alone can fail to provide nighttime relief if airflow is ignored. A and B may be useful, while D and E reflect the sort of broader planning the passage encourages.

Q6 (Reading Comprehension; source rc-006) - Correct: F

Sentence F explicitly states the planning conclusion: vegetation should be located with attention to geometry and temperature cycles. Sentence E names a distinction planners make, but F directly states the practical implication of that distinction.

Q7 (Reading Comprehension; source rc-007) - Correct: B

The author grants that the images can be comic but argues that they can also mark, extend, or complicate a text. A is too narrow, C and D are unsupported generalizations, and E conflicts with the passage's interpretive examples.

Q8 (Reading Comprehension; source rc-008) - Correct: B

The example supports the claim that a marginal image may do more than amuse: it can visually echo an idea in the text. The other choices add unsupported claims about replacement, frequency, chronology, or fixed meaning.

Q9 (Reading Comprehension; source rc-009) - Correct: A, B

The passage states that marginal images could mark a section and extend an argument by visual analogy, supporting A and B. It emphasizes dependence on context and collaborators, so C is not supported.

Q10 (Reading Comprehension; source rc-010) - Correct: B

The passage contrasts measurable efficiency gains with the loss of an informal reporting channel. A, D, and E are too absolute or contrary to the passage, and C turns a specific observation into a broad generalization.

Q11 (Reading Comprehension; source rc-011) - Correct: B

The volunteers' concern is that rotating drivers weakened a channel for early problem reporting. Choice B directly supports that causal link. A may be an efficiency benefit, and C, D, and E do not address the reporting mechanism.

Q12 (Reading Comprehension; source rc-012) - Correct: C

Sentence C begins with a contrast and supplies the volunteers' observation that complicates the managers' efficiency-focused assessment. Sentence D explains the mechanism, while E states the overall conclusion.

Q13 (Reading Comprehension; source rc-013) - Correct: B

The passage says returning bird species are useful indicators but not conclusive proof of functional recovery. A is too strong, C and D are not the main focus, and E reverses the described practice.

Q14 (Reading Comprehension; source rc-014) - Correct: A

The researchers recommend additional measures because bird presence can occur before slower habitat recovery. Choice A gives the relevant reason. C is a possible reason birds visit but does not by itself establish incomplete recovery; E reverses the passage's timing claim.

Q15 (Reading Comprehension; source rc-015) - Correct: A, B

The passage explicitly recommends pairing bird surveys with vegetation structure and invertebrate abundance, among other measures. C repeats the limited practice the researchers consider insufficient when used alone.

Q16 (Text Completion; source tc-001) - Correct: Blank 1: B

The memorandum dismisses every compromise, so it is uncompromising or intransigent. Placatory is tempting because of the public statement, but the blank describes the contrasting private memorandum.

Q17 (Text Completion; source tc-002) - Correct: Blank 1: A

The ability of new users to complete complex tasks without the manual indicates that the interface was easy to understand, or intuitive. Ornate and opaque may describe interfaces, but they would not explain the users' success.

Q18 (Text Completion; source tc-003) - Correct: Blank 1: A

The clause after the semicolon says she avoids theatrical denunciation, so her prose is not polemical. Judicious is tempting because the behavior is measured, but the sentence says what the prose is not.

Q19 (Text Completion; source tc-004) - Correct: Blank 1: A; Blank 2: D

The contrast between praise and warning suggests that the concept was creative but not technically workable. Ingenuity and impracticable fit this logic; lavish does not explain an engineering warning, and transparent would be positive.

Q20 (Text Completion; source tc-005) - Correct: Blank 1: A; Blank 2: E

The board's abrupt change from cursory approvals to heavy documentation suggests inconsistency rather than genuine carefulness. Scrupulousness names the benign interpretation being rejected, and caprice captures the criticism.

Q21 (Text Completion; source tc-006) - Correct: Blank 1: A; Blank 2: E

The 'not...rather' structure indicates that the editor did not remove the eccentricity but clarified its purpose. Standardize is what she was not doing, and discernible describes oddities made easier to perceive. Amplify would not contrast cleanly with the second clause.

Q22 (Text Completion; source tc-007) - Correct: Blank 1: A; Blank 2: D; Blank 3: G

The sentence praises balance: the biographer acknowledges positive evidence, does not let one kind of evidence eclipse the other, and reaches a nuanced judgment. Peremptory would imply excessive certainty, not careful balance.

Q23 (Text Completion; source tc-008) - Correct: Blank 1: A; Blank 2: E; Blank 3: H

A failed replication would initially seem to discredit the original study. If the replication used a contaminated reagent, it is irrelevant as contrary evidence, so the debate remains unresolved. Decisive and settled contradict the audit's effect.

Q24 (Text Completion; source tc-009) - Correct: Blank 1: A; Blank 2: E; Blank 3: G

The opening promises a strong defense, but the essay wanders into irrelevant anecdotes. Cogent fits the promised argument, desultory fits the wandering execution, and diffusion captures the loss of focus. Focused and incisive contradict the digression.

Q25 (Sentence Equivalence; source se-001) - Correct: Blank 1: B, D

Avoiding broad pronouncements and deciding only a narrow issue points to an opinion that is circumscribed or limited. Sweeping and expansive form a tempting pair but mean the opposite in context.

Q26 (Sentence Equivalence; source se-002) - Correct: Blank 1: B, C

Repeatedly changing the account in response to evidence makes the testimony seem malleable or adaptable. Immutable and unassailable are nearly favorable in legal contexts but contradict the described revisions.

Q27 (Sentence Equivalence; source se-003) - Correct: Blank 1: C, E

Visitors filling every gallery indicates that the opening was well attended or popular. Muted and understated are a tempting pair, but they conflict with the unexpectedly large response.

Q28 (Sentence Equivalence; source se-004) - Correct: Blank 1: A, C

The problem is not pessimism but weak assumptions, so the forecast is untenable or indefensible. Dire and gloomy are tempting synonyms, but the sentence explicitly says disaster was not the issue.

Q29 (Sentence Equivalence; source se-005) - Correct: Blank 1: B, E

The lectures were difficult but not hard to understand because examples clarified them; opaque and inscrutable fit what students rarely found them to be. Taxing and arduous are tempting synonyms, but the sentence concedes that the lectures were demanding.

Q30 (Sentence Equivalence; source se-006) - Correct: Blank 1: A, C

A repackaging of existing services is derivative or imitative. Novel and visionary match the founders' claim but not the investors' assessment; profitable and precarious are not supported by the sentence.

Q31 (Reading Comprehension; source rc-001) - Correct: B

The passage presents leaf-wax analysis as valuable but not self-sufficient, emphasizing alternative explanations and the need for independent evidence. A and E are too negative, while C and D overstate the role of other evidence.

Q32 (Reading Comprehension; source rc-002) - Correct: D

The passage repeatedly warns that a shift in isotope ratios has multiple possible causes and is persuasive only with corroboration. D makes the kind of isolated, conclusive claim the researchers would reject.

Q33 (Reading Comprehension; source rc-003) - Correct: A, B, C

The passage explicitly lists changes in precipitation, changes in plant sources, and increases in reworked sediments as possible explanations for isotope shifts. All three choices are supported.

Q34 (Reading Comprehension; source rc-004) - Correct: C

The passage argues that courts were not merely applying fixed customs; they were places where norms were asserted, contested, and stabilized. A and D make the rules too fixed, B dismisses the records too strongly, and E overstates novelty.

Q35 (Reading Comprehension; source rc-005) - Correct: A

The passage says written judgments often appeared after litigants requested them and may overrepresent conflicts involving unsettled rules. A captures that sampling concern; the other choices are unsupported or contradicted.

Q36 (Reading Comprehension; source rc-006) - Correct: D

Sentence D explicitly explains why the surviving archive may overrepresent a certain kind of case. The other sentences state the prior view, the revised view, evidence of dispute, or the passage's conclusion.

Q37 (Reading Comprehension; source rc-007) - Correct: B

The passage warns that clusters are not automatically biological kinds and recommends validating them with other methods. A and D replace rather than supplement computational classification, while C and E overgeneralize.

Q38 (Reading Comprehension; source rc-008) - Correct: A

The stressed-cell example illustrates an artifact: preparation can alter transcription and make cells cluster together. The passage does not claim that stressed cells are especially important or that sequencing is useless.

Q39 (Reading Comprehension; source rc-009) - Correct: A, B

A and B are both reasons the passage gives for caution. C states the assumption the passage warns against, so it is not supported.

Q40 (Reading Comprehension; source rc-010) - Correct: B

The passage treats notation as indispensable but partial, and it argues for combining sources while explaining interpretive decisions. A rejects notation too strongly, C privileges film without support, and E reverses the final sentence.

Q41 (Reading Comprehension; source rc-011) - Correct: B

Notation records steps and patterns but rarely captures gesture weight, hesitation, or performer rapport. C describes film, D describes reviews, and A and E contradict the passage's account of notation's usefulness.

Q42 (Reading Comprehension; source rc-012) - Correct: E

Sentence E explicitly identifies when a reconstruction is strongest. Sentence F further explains fidelity, but E most directly states the standard asked for in the stem.

Q43 (Reading Comprehension; source rc-013) - Correct: B

The passage does not reject ratings; it argues that averages can conceal patterns and must be interpreted with distributions, comments, and sampling procedures. B captures this qualified position.

Q44 (Reading Comprehension; source rc-014) - Correct: A

The passage contrasts moderate scores spread broadly with excellent ratings mixed with a few very low ratings that may reveal recurring failures. A captures why equal averages can call for different responses.

Q45 (Reading Comprehension; source rc-015) - Correct: A, B, C

The passage explicitly says analysts recommend examining distributions, comments, and sampling procedures before drawing managerial conclusions. All three choices are supported.

Q46 (Text Completion; source tc-001) - Correct: Blank 1: A

The specialists' complaint indicates that the proposal handled neighboring fields superficially, so perfunctory fits. Integrative and exhaustive would support the interdisciplinary claim rather than undercut it.

Q47 (Text Completion; source tc-002) - Correct: Blank 1: A

The dashboard appears transparent but leaves users unsure, so it is effectively opaque. The other choices do not capture the mismatch between apparent openness and actual comprehensibility.

Q48 (Text Completion; source tc-003) - Correct: Blank 1: B

The objection is that the experiments lack narrative purpose, making them gratuitous. Innovative is tempting because the sentence mentions experimentation, but the criticism concerns function, not novelty.

Q49 (Text Completion; source tc-004) - Correct: Blank 1: A; Blank 2: D

The mayor's praise implies the program looked promising, but a missing control group makes the evidence hard to interpret. Above reproach contradicts the methodological flaw, and irrelevant overstates the problem.

Q50 (Text Completion; source tc-005) - Correct: Blank 1: A; Blank 2: D

Removing local references would make the poem less particularized but more universal. Provincial would move in the opposite direction, and cryptic is not implied by generality.

Q51 (Text Completion; source tc-006) - Correct: Blank 1: A; Blank 2: D

The 'claimed...yet' structure contrasts a promise to broaden the mission with a plan that trustees saw as narrowing it. Constrictive captures their objection; balanced and philanthropic are unsupported.

Q52 (Text Completion; source tc-007) - Correct: Blank 1: A; Blank 2: D; Blank 3: G

The minutes have been treated as decisive opposition, but they only show hesitation about timing. Thus the cited evidence is supposedly unequivocal, actually equivocal, and the error is to inflate a procedural worry into a veto.

Q53 (Text Completion; source tc-008) - Correct: Blank 1: A; Blank 2: D; Blank 3: G

A reputation for dogmatism is puzzling if the work resists final answers. The final clause says the method is rigorous but not doctrinaire. Systematic fits rigorous rather than the contrast, and digressive is unsupported.

Q54 (Text Completion; source tc-009) - Correct: Blank 1: A; Blank 2: D; Blank 3: G

Multiple letters initially appear to corroborate the account, but their shared source means the support is illusory and the evidence remains fragile. Independent and cumulative would be true only if the letters had separate origins.

Q55 (Sentence Equivalence; source se-001) - Correct: Blank 1: B, D

Answering a narrower procedural objection while avoiding the ethical issue makes the reply evasive or oblique. Forthright and explicit form a tempting favorable pair but conflict with the avoidance described.

Q56 (Sentence Equivalence; source se-002) - Correct: Blank 1: B, D

Renaming categories without changing the underlying criteria is merely cosmetic or superficial. Rigorous and exhaustive imply substantive value, while provisional and contentious are not established by the sentence.

Q57 (Sentence Equivalence; source se-003) - Correct: Blank 1: B, C

Acknowledging strengths before criticizing a limiting assumption indicates a measured or balanced tone. Dismissive, caustic, and hostile overstate the criticism; indifferent ignores the careful evaluation.

Q58 (Sentence Equivalence; source se-004) - Correct: Blank 1: B, D

The report's omission of the one-time bequest makes its claim about rising donations misleading or deceptive. Celebratory may describe its tone but not the effect of the omission, and comprehensive and meticulous contradict it.

Q59 (Sentence Equivalence; source se-005) - Correct: Blank 1: B, C

A defender who carefully lists evidence that could overturn the theory is not rigidly committed to it, so not doctrinaire and not dogmatic fit. Skeptical, cautious, and tentative are tempting but describe qualities her behavior actually suggests.

Q60 (Sentence Equivalence; source se-006) - Correct: Blank 1: B, D

A report made by stitching together incompatible recommendations is incoherent or inconsistent. Conciliatory explains the motive but not the resulting logical problem; unanimous and meticulous are unsupported.